



Sivaramakrishnan Kalyanaraman
Vice President-HR
Intelligroup, Inc.

“We believe that basics and foundation are mandatory for success. These cannot be achieved through crash courses. Crash courses pander to people’s insecurities, and we believe that better candidates would not be attracted to them. We give relative weightage of 50:50 to qualifications held and the skills possessed by an applicant—both are equally necessary. Formal education provides the foundation for the concepts that can be built upon in the corporate world.

“Standardised tests give us a uniform benchmark for us to assess all candidates. Variations in the curricula of different universities will thus be compensated for.

“From a candidate with experience, we expect solid basic concepts, understanding of the workspace, working in a team and lateral thinking. We also expect the person to understand the requirements of the client and work with customer delight in mind. We look for people with good adaptability and learning abilities, and believe that good performance at work can erase the deficiencies of academic performance.

“Today, the requirement to demonstrate skills is already gaining importance, and will continue to do so.”



BOOKWORM OR

Do skillsets possessed merit over qualifications? We asked IT industry bigwigs and found out the current trend



Shomit Khemka,
CEO,
Synapse Communications
Pvt. Ltd.

“Any educational degree which is obtained from an accredited institute has weight, and given preference not only in the government sector, but in the private sector as well. Many private institutes have mushroomed recently, some of which follow the basic principle of earning money rather than adding desired value to the candidates.

“If a candidate has formal qualifications, it tells us that he / she has grown up to that level, which works a launching pad to take him further. That is why at the time of recruiting, the requirements clearly state that formal education is required to go ahead.

“Standardised tests, according to me, would work better if candidates have already taken the first flight—formal education.

“For a regular position, we go through a formal assessment through interviews, written test, HR interviews, reference checks, etc. On-the-spot hiring is limited to campus recruitment only.

“At Synapse, we value knowledge and skills, but a formal education is an essential requirement. Once candidates are hired, what really matters is their performance, and academic scores take a back seat.

“Formal education can give you a launching pad, but it’s your grit and performance that will enable you to take-off.”